

• DATABASE BASICS

SQL vs NoSQL

The 60-second guide every developer should read before choosing a database. 🙌

● RELATIONAL

What is SQL?

Data lives in **tables** with rows & columns. A fixed **schema** keeps everything structured and consistent.

- ✓ Structured, predictable data
- ✓ Strong relationships & JOINS
- ✓ ACID transactions

● NON-RELATIONAL

What is NoSQL?

Flexible data stored as **documents, key-values, graphs** or wide-columns. No rigid schema required.

- ✓ Flexible, evolving schema
- ✓ Built to scale horizontally
- ✓ Great for huge, varied data

• HEAD TO HEAD

Key differences

FEATURE	SQL	NOSQL
Schema	Fixed	Dynamic
Structure	Tables	Docs / K-V / Graph
Scaling	Vertical	Horizontal
Best for	Complex queries	Speed & scale
Consistency	Strong (ACID)	Eventual (BASE)

Choose by need, not hype

→

- SAME TASK, TWO STYLES

Find all active users

SQL

```
SELECT * FROM  
users  
WHERE status =  
'active';
```

NoSQL

```
db.users.find(  
  { status:  
    "active" }  
);
```

• PICK THE RIGHT TOOL

When to use what

Choose SQL

- ▷ Banking & payments
- ▷ Complex reporting
- ▷ Strict data integrity

Choose NoSQL

- ▷ Real-time & chat apps
- ▷ IoT & big data streams
- ▷ Rapidly changing data

Many apps use both



● THE TAKEAWAY

There is no “better”. Only the **right fit**.

SQL wins on **structure & consistency**. NoSQL wins on **flexibility & scale**. Match the database to your data and your growth.

 **SQL or NoSQL for your project? Comment below!**

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